

Class 24

Health, Environment, and Externalities

Part IV — Governing Capitalism's Consequences

Air pollution falls while GDP rises

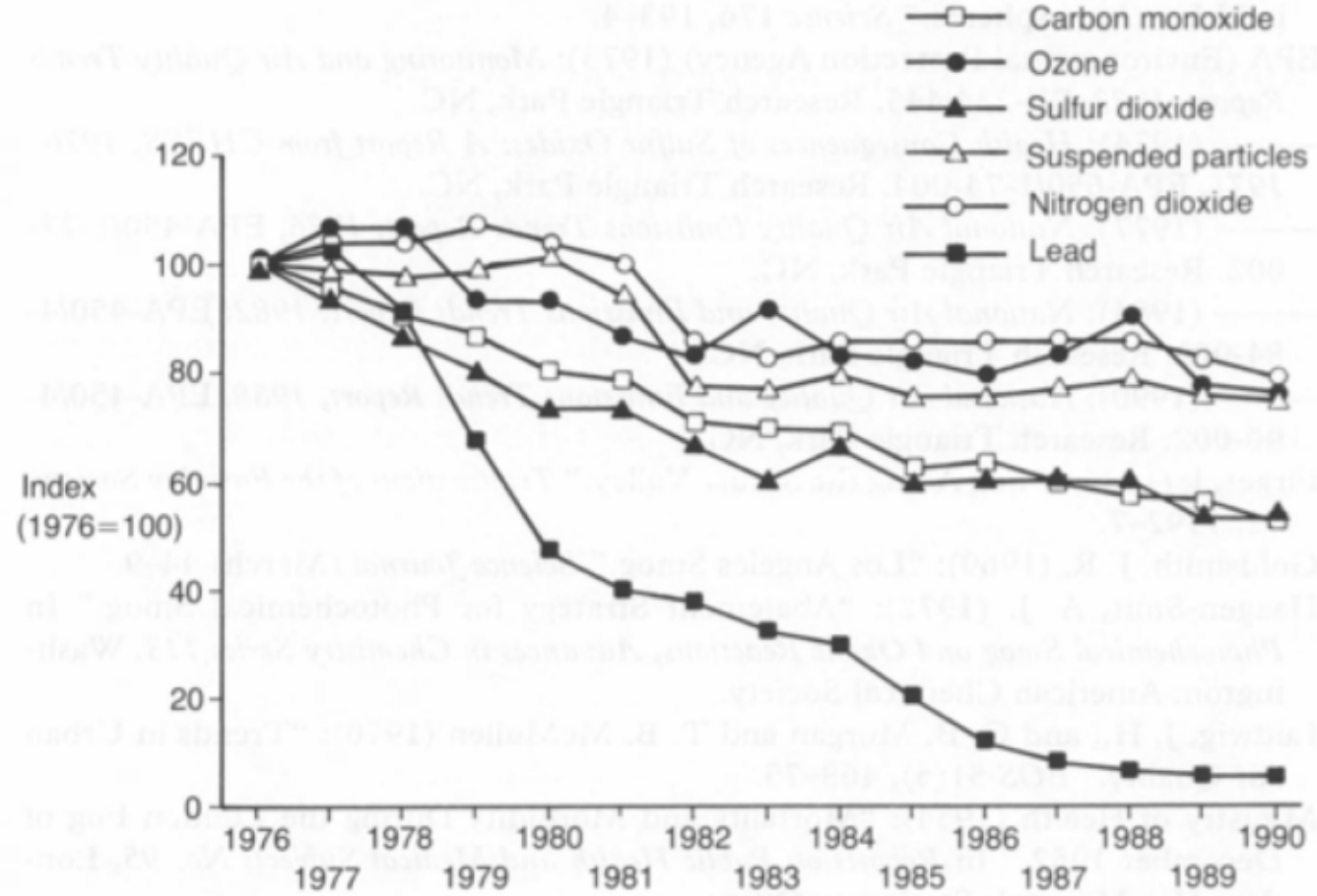


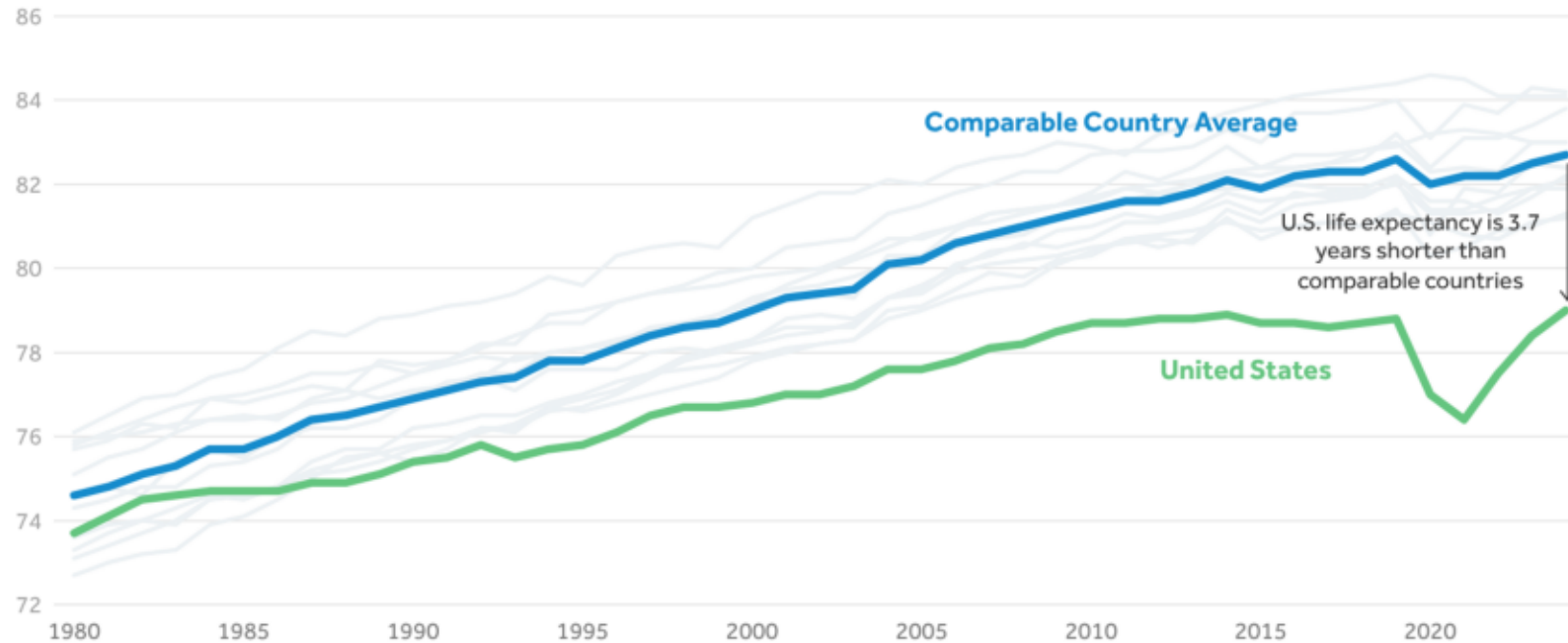
Figure 45.4 Ambient air pollutant concentrations, USA, 1976–90

Source: US Environmental Protection Agency, National Air Quality and Emissions Trends Report, annual.

The U.S. spends more on health, but lives shorter lives

In 2024, Life Expectancy in the U.S. Reached an All-time High of 79 but Remained Years Behind the Average in Comparable Countries

Life expectancy at birth, in years, 1980-2024



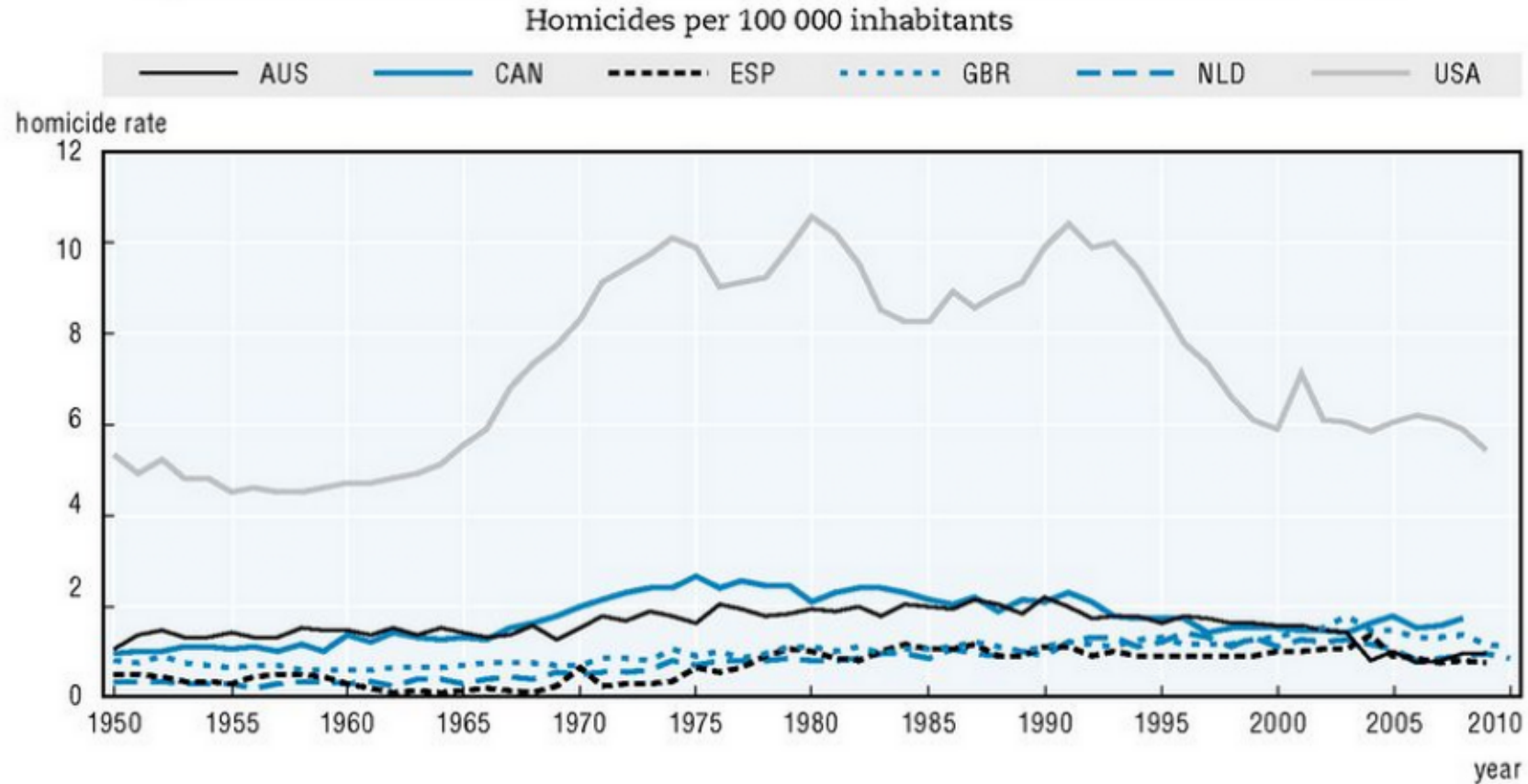
Notes: Comparable countries include Australia, Austria, Belgium, Canada, France, Germany, Japan, the Netherlands, Sweden, Switzerland, and the U.K. See Methods section of "How does U.S. life expectancy compare to other countries?"

Source: KFF analysis of life expectancy data from the OECD and official health and statistics department websites.

Peterson-KFF
Health System Tracker

The U.S. is not converging to other rich countries

Figure 8.1. Homicide rates in selected Western countries, 1950-2010



Note: For an assessment of data quality, see Table 8.2.

Source: Clio-Infra, www.clio-infra.eu.

StatLink  <http://dx.doi.org/10.1787/888933095932>

The rise — and recent U.S. stall — in life expectancy

